There is something special about the Town Panchayat. Can anyone tell me what is it?", asked Namburajan. Everyone was gazing at him. But none answered.

"Well, I'll tell the answer myself.

Tamil Nadu was the first state to introduce a town Panchayat in the whole of India".

All were amazed on hearing it.

A City Municipal Corporation has a **Commissioner,** who is an Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer. Government officials are deputed as **Commissioners** for the municipalities. The administrative officer of a Municipality is an **Executive Officer** (EO).

"You mentioned about Panchayats and Panchayat Unions".

The **Village Panchayats** are the local bodies of villages. They act as a link between the people and the government. Villages are divided into wards based on their population. The representatives are elected by the people.



The Elected Representatives

1. Panchayat President
2. Ward members
3. Councillor
4. District Panchayat
   Ward Councillor

Panchayat Union

Many village Panchayats join to form a **Panchayat Union**. A **Councillor** is elected from each Panchayat, isn't it? Those councillors will elect a Panchayat Union **Chairperson** among themselves. A **Vice Chairperson** is also elected. A **Block Development Officer** (BDO) is the administrative head, of a Panchayat Union.

The services are provided on the Panchayat Union level.

DO YOU KNOW?

The Nilgiris and **Perambalur** Districts have the lowest number of Panchayat Unions (4).

District Panchayat

A District Panchayat is formed in every district. A district is divided into wards on the basis of 50,000 population. The ward members are elected by the Village Panchayats. The members of the District Panchayat elect the **District Panchayat Committee Chairperson.** They provide essential services and facilities to the rural population and the planning and execution of development programmes for the district.

The local bodies are governed by the representatives elected by the people. The constituencies are called wards. People elect their ward members.

The Mayor of the City Municipal Corporation and the **Municipal Chairperson** are the elected representatives of the people. The people elect them. The Corporation **Deputy Mayor** and the Municipal **Vice Chairperson** are elected by the ward councillors" finished Namburajan.

"What are the benefits of local bodies, uncle?"

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